MOCK TEST 66

📖 READING

5 parts · 35 questions

⏱ 60 minutes

Vaqt: 60 daqiqa. Javoblarni javoblar varaqasiga o'tkazishni unutmang.

PART 1

Questions 1–6

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

CANNABIS AND CANCER

For thousands of years people have used cannabis for recreational, ritualistic and medicinal purposes. In the modern era, the latter property excites a lot of people, and there is no shortage of wild claims about the supposed medical benefits of the plant. Of all the **Q1**_____, perhaps the most bold is the assertion that cannabis can cure cancer. Astounding testimonials about cannabis and its derived products shrinking tumours or curing terminal cases are easy to find on the internet. But alluring as these stories are, they tend to be based on misunderstanding, wishful thinking or outright falsehood. Let's start by asking what the **Q2**_____ efficacy might be. Contrary to what most people believe, medical uses of cannabis have been widely studied. A 2017 review by the National Academy of Science looked at over 10,000 studies. They found evidence for some applications of cannabis, including managing chronic pain and spasms associated with multiple sclerosis. There was also good **Q3**_____ that tetrahydrocannabinol (THC), the main psychoactive ingredient in cannabis, can reduce the nausea caused by chemotherapy. Indeed, a synthetic form of THC, called dronabinol, has been prescribed for just this use for decades. But, crucially, there is zero evidence that cannabis has any curative or even helpful impact on **Q4**_____ despite enthusiastic claims to the contrary. Why then is there such a gulf between public perception and scientific evidence? Part of this is **Q5**_____ For example, an often aired claim is that high-dose THC kills cancer cells in a petri dish. This is true, but not very meaningful. Killing cells in a dish is extremely easy; you can do so with anything from heat to bleach. But effective anti-cancer agents must be able to selectively kill cancer **Q6**_____ in the human body while sparing healthy ones. The reality is that cannabis simply cannot do this.

PART 2

Questions 7–14

The people below all want to do a local activity. There are eight activities in the local area. Decide which activity would be the most suitable for the people below.

7

You have a teenage son who is very keen to get into acting and learning how best to perform on stage. Because of other activities he cannot do Saturdays or Sundays.

8

You are 21 and on summer vacation before going back to university. You are looking for voluntary work that will help you gain experience in working with customers.

9

You would like to take your children to the park one day next week. You would like to show them the importance of doing something for local people.

10

You are a new mum with a three-month-old baby and are looking for exercise to help relax. You are free on Monday and Tuesday and love getting a bargain!

11

You are looking for somewhere to take your son for something to eat at lunchtime any day this week. He would like to go somewhere that is outside to get some fresh air.

12

You have decided to join a gym. You want to have someone who can help and encourage you to work hard. You'd also like to go swimming at the weekend.

13

You are looking for a personal trainer and are returning to exercise after hurting your ankle. You are busy at work and need someone who is available any day.

14

You are a keen athlete and want to find somewhere you can train on a race-track and compete against other athletes. You like to train early in the morning.

A) Friends of Hamley Park Come along to 'Friends of Hamley Park' for our monthly litter pick. Join our friendly team of adults and children every Sunday to help us keep our lovely local park tidy and something to be proud of. We provide all the tools and equipment you'll need. Just come along on the day and we'll find something for you to do.

B) Yoga sessions Yoga sessions with Petra aimed at your level. I know how important it can be for you mums to get out of the house and do some exercise. My fun weekly 'Mum and Child' yoga classes start on Monday 18 June. Buy five sessions and get one free

C) Broadchester Park You are invited to come along for our weekly picnic in Broadchester Park. Open to all,young and old, it's held every Tuesday throughout the summer at 12.00. Please note there will be a charge for food which will be supplied by the café.

D) JDC Gym We offer personal, one-to-one training programmes for beginner and more advanced workouts. Our trainers are available seven days a week and can meet you at the gym or at a place that's more convenient to you. Build your strength and fitness and get help with any injuries you may have.

E) Storytelling Storytelling has become popular lately, especially for those who want to tell their story on stage in front of a live audience. Join our one-day event on Wednesday – we'll be looking at how to feel confident and keep your audience interested.

F) Time to relax A new six-week yoga course for beginners. Help yourself become more focused, reduce your stress levels, sleep better and improve your mental health. I will be running these courses in the local community centre on Wednesday and Thursday mornings from 11.00 till 12.00. Childcare is available for babies and young children.

G) The community café Our community café is looking for young volunteer waiters and waitresses to help us throughout the summer period. You'll learn skills that will be useful when you start your job search. We're looking for anyone who is at least 18 and would like you to be available for at least two days per week.

H) Sport Special For those who want to focus on their own personal fitness, Sport Special provides members with a modern gym with the latest equipment. The leisure centre also organises group events such as five-a-side football or hockey. After the match, get to know your team mates in the café for tea, coffee and snacks.

I) Stevie's Gym Stevie's Gym is well known in the area for offering the best in everything to do with health and fitness. Relax in our luxury swimming pool or use the latest equipment in the gym. It's easyto lose interest if you don't have the right support, and our skilled team of trainers will get you started and help you stay focused.

J) Central Fitness and Leisure We are one of the larger leisure centres in the area and can offer a huge range of activities at our 24-hour gym and 400-metre running track that is free to use for members. Sign up to our monthly league table and see how your times compare to other members.

K) The Arcadian Harriers We meet in the Arcadian Leisure Centre twice a week and set off on planned routes around the area. Join us on Tuesday for the 6k run and Thursday for the 10k. You don't have to become a member to run with us, but we'd love it if you did. We are also looking for people to help out with events.

PART 3

Questions 15–20

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

A) Common objections
B) Who's planning what
C) This type sells best in the shops
D) The figures say it all
E) Early trials
F) They can't get in without these
G) How does it work?
H) Fighting fraud
I) Systems to avoid
J) Accepting the inevitable

15. Paragraph 1 **16. Paragraph 2** **17. Paragraph 3**
18. Paragraph 4 **19. Paragraph 5** **20. Paragraph 6**

THE KEYLESS SOCIETY

1. Students who want to enter the University of Montreal's Athletic Complex need more than just a conventional ID card - their identities must be authenticated by an electronic hand scanner. In some California housing estates, a key alone is insufficient to get someone in the door; his or her voice print must also be verified. And soon, customers at some Japanese banks will have to present their faces for scanning before they can enter the building and withdraw their money.

2. All of these are applications of biometrics, a little-known but fast- growing technology that involves the use of physical or biological characteristics to identify individuals. In use for more than a decade at some high- security government institutions in the United States and Canada, biometrics are now rapidly popping up in the everyday world. Already, more than 10,000 facilities, from prisons to day-care centres, monitor people's fingerprints or other physical parts to ensure that they are who they claim to be. Some 60 biometric companies around the world pulled in at least $22 million last year and that grand total is expected to mushroom to at least $50 million by 1999.

3. Biometric security systems operate by storing a digitised record of some unique human feature. When an authorised user wishes to enter or use the facility, the system scans the person's corresponding characteristics and attempts to match them against those on record. Systems using fingerprints, hands, voices, irises, retinas and faces are already on the market. Others using typing patterns and even body odours are in various stages of develo pme nt.

4. Fingerprint scanners are currently the most widely deployed type of biometric application, thanks to their growing use over the last 20 years by law-enforcement agencies. Sixteen American states now use biometric fingerprint verification systems to check that people claiming welfare payments are genuine. In June, politicians in Toronto voted to do the same, with a pilot project beginning next year.

5. To date, the most widely used commercial biometric system is the handkey, a type of hand scanner which reads the unique shape, size and irregularities of people's hands. Originally developed for nuclear powerplants, the handkey received its big

break when it was used to control access to the Olympic Village in Atlanta by more than 65,000 athletes, trainers and support staff Now there are scores of other applications.

6. Around the world, the market is growing rapidly. Malaysia, for example, is preparing to equip all of its airports with biometric face scanners to match passengers with luggage. And Japan's largest maker of cash dispensers is developing new machines that incorporate iris scanners. The first commercial biometric, a hand reader used by an American firm to monitor employee attendance, was introduced in 1974. But only in the past few years has the technology improved enough for the prices to drop sufficiently to make them commercially viable. 'When we started four years ago, I had to explain to everyone what a biometric is,' says one marketing expert. Now, there's much more awareness out there.'

PART 4 Questions 21–29

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

THE CREATION OF LASTING MEMORIES

Many studies of the brain processes underlying the creation of memory consolidation (lasting memories) have involved giving various human and animal subjects treatment, while training them to perform a task. These have contributed greatly to our understanding.

In pioneering studies using goldfish, Bernard Agranoff found that protein synthesis inhibitors injected after training caused the goldfish to forget what they had learned. In other experiments, he administered protein synthesis inhibitors immediately before the fish were trained. The remarkable finding was that the fish learned the task completely normally, but forgot it within a few hours - that is, the protein synthesis inhibitors blocked memory consolidation, but did not influence short-term memory.

There is now extensive evidence that short-term memory is spared by many kinds of treatments, including electro-convulsive therapy (ECT), that block memory consolidation. On the other hand, and equally importantly, neuroscientist Ivan Izquierdo found that many drug treatments can block short-term memory without blocking memory consolidation.

Contrary to the hypothesis put forward by Canadian psychologist Donald Hebb, in 1949, long-term memory does not require short-term memory, and vice versa. Such findings suggest that our experiences create parallel, and possibly independent stages of memory, .each with a different life span. All of this evidence from clinical and experimental studies strongly indicates that the brain handles recent and remote memory in different ways; but why does it do that?

We obviously need to have memory that is created rapidly: reacting to an ever and rapidly changing environment requires that. For example, most current building codes require that the heights of all steps in a staircase be equal. After taking a couple of steps, up or down, we implicitly remember the heights of the steps and assume that the others will be the same. If they are not the same, we are very likely to trip and fall. Lack of this kind of rapidly created implicit memory would be bad for us and for insurance companies, but perhaps good for lawyers. It would be of little value to us if we remembered the heights of the steps only after a delay of many hours, when the memory becomes consolidated. The hypothesis that lasting memory consolidates slowly over time is supported primarily by clinical and experimental evidence that the formation of long-term memory is influenced by treatments and disorders affecting brain functioning. There are also other kinds of evidence indicating more directly that the memories consolidate over time after learning. Avi Kami and Dov Sagi reported that the performance of human subjects trained in a visual skill did not improve until eight hours after the training was completed, and that improvement was even greater the following day. Furthermore, the skill was retained for several years.

Studies using human brain imaging to study changes in neural activity induced by learning have also reported that the changes continue to develop for hours after learning. In an innovative study using functional imaging of the brain, Reza Shadmehr and Henry Holcomb examined brain activity in several brain regions shortly after human subjects were trained in a motor learning task requiring arm and hand movements. They found that while the performance of the subjects remained stable for several hours after completion of the training, their brain activity did not; different regions of the brain were predominantly active at different times over a period of several hours after the training. The activity shifted from the prefrontal cortex to two areas known to be involved in controlling movements, the motor cortex and cerebellar cortex. Consolidation of the motor skill appeared to involve activation of different neural systems that increased the stability of the brain processes underlying the skill.

There is also evidence that learning-induced changes in the activity of neurons in the cerebral cortex continue to increase for many days after the training. In an extensive series of studies using rats with electrodes implanted in the auditory cortex, Norman Weinberger reported that, after a tone of specific frequency was paired a few times with footshock, neurons in the rats' auditory cortex responded more to that specific tone and less to other tones of other frequencies. Even more interestingly, the selectivity of the neurons' response to the specific tone used in training continued to increase for several days after the training was terminated.

It is not intuitively obvious why our lasting memories consolidate slowly. Certainly, one can wonder why we have a form of memory that we have to rely on for many hours, days or a lifetime, that is so susceptible to disruption shortly after it is initiated. Perhaps the brain system that consolidates long-term memory over time was a late development in vertebrate evolution. Moreover, maybe we consolidate memories slowly because our mammalian brains are large and enormously complex. We can readily reject these ideas. All species of animals studied to date have both short and long-term memory; and all are susceptible to retrograde amnesia. Like humans, birds, bees, and molluscs, as well as fish and rats, make long-term memory slowly. Consolidation of memory clearly emerged early in evolution, and was conserved. Although there seems to be no compelling reason to conclude that a biological system such as a brain could not quickly make a lasting memory, the fact is that animal brains do not. Thus, memory consolidation must serve some very important adaptive function or functions. There is considerable evidence suggesting that the slow consolidation is adaptive because it enables neurobiological processes occurring shortly after learning to influence the strength of memory for experiences. The extensive evidence that memory can be enhanced, as well as impaired, by treatments administered

shortly after training, provides intriguing support for this hypothesis.

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

21 **Experiments by Bernard Agranoff described in Reading Passage involved**

A) injecting goldfish at different stages of the experiments.
B) training goldfish to do different types of task.
C) using different types of treatment on goldfish.
D) comparing the performance of different goldfish on certain tasks.

22 **Most findings from recent studies suggest that**

A) drug treatments do not normally affect short-term memories.
B) long-term memories build upon short-term memories.
C) short and long-term memories are formed by separate processes.
D) ECT treatment affects both short-and long-term memories.

23 **In the fifth paragraph, what does the writer want to show by the example of staircases?**

A) Prompt memory formation underlies the performance of everyday tasks.
B) Routine tasks can be carried out unconsciously.
C) Physical accidents can impair the function of memory.
D) Complex information such as regulations cannot be retained by the memory.

24 **Observations about memory by Kami and Sagi**

A) cast doubt on existing hypotheses.
B) related only to short-term memory.
C) were based on tasks involving hearing.
D) confirmed other experimental findings.

25 **What did the experiment by Shadmehr and Holcomb show?**

A) Different areas of the brain were activated by different tasks.
B) Activity in the brain gradually moved from one area to other areas.
C) Subjects continued to get better at a task after training had finished.
D) Treatment given to subjects improved their performance on a task.

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage?

26 **The training which Kami and Sagi's subjects were given was repeated over several days.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

27 **The rats in Weinberger's studies learned to associate a certain sound with a specific experience.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

28 **The results of Weinberger's studies indicated that the strength of the rats' learned associations increases with time.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

29 **It is easy to see the evolutionary advantage of the way lasting memories in humans are created.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

PART 5 Questions 30–35

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

TALC POWDER

High in the French Pyrenees, some 1,700m above see level, lies Trimouns, a huge deposit of hydrated magnesium silicate - talc to you and me. Talc from Trimouns, and from ten other Luzenac mines across the globe, is used in the manufacture of a vast array of everyday products extending from paper, paint and plaster to cosmetics, plastics and car tyres. And of course there is always talc's best known end use: talcum powder for babies' bottoms. But the true versatility of this remarkable mineral is nowhere better displayed than in its sometimes surprising use in certain niche markets in the food and agriculture industries.

Take, for example, the chewing gum business. Every year, Talc de Luzenac France—which owns and operates the Trimouns mine and is a member of the international Luzenac Group (art of Rio Tinto minerals)—supplies about 6,000 tones of talc to chewing gum manufacturers in Europe. "We've been selling to this sector of the market since the 1960s,"says Laurent Fournier, sales manager in Luzenac's Specialties business unit in Toulouse. "Admittedly, in terms of our total annual sales of talc, the amount we supply to chewing gum manufacturers is relatively small, but we see it as a valuable niche market: one where customers place a premium on securing supplies from a reliable, high quality source. Because of this, long term allegiance to a proven suppler is very much a feature of this sector of the talc market."Switching sources—in the way that you might choose to buy, say, paperclips from Supplier A rather than from Supplier B —is not a easy option for chewing gum manufacturers,"Fournier says. "The cost of reformulating is high, so when customers are using a talc grade that works, even if it's expensive, they are understandably reluctant to switch."

But how is talc actually used in the manufacture of chewing gum? PatrickDelord, an engineer with a degree in agronomics, who has been with Luzenac for 22 years and is now senior market development manager, Agriculture and Food, in Europe, explains that chewing gums has four main components. "The most important of them is the gum base, "he says. "It's the gum base that puts the chew into chewing gum. It binds all the ingredients together, creating a soft, smooth texture. To this the manufacturer then adds sweeteners, softeners and flavourings. Our talc is used as a filler in the gum base. The amount varies between, say, ten and 35 per cent, depending on the type of gum. Fruit flavoured chewing gum, for example, is slightly acidic and would react with the calcium carbonate that the manufacturer might otherwise use as a filler. Talc, on the other hand, makes an ideal filler because it's non-reactive chemically.

In the factory, talc is also used to dust the gum base pellets and to stop the chewing gum sticking during the lamination and packing process, "Delord adds.

The chewing gum business is, however, just one example of talc's use in the food sector. For the past 20 years or so, olive oil processors in Spain have been taking advantage of talc's unique characteristics to help them boost the amount of oil they extract from crushed olives. According to Patrick Delord, talc is especially useful for treating what he calls "difficult" olives. After the olives are harvested-preferably early in the morning because their taste is better if they are gathered in the cool of the day - they are taken to the processing plant. There they are crushed and then stirred for 30-45 minutes. In the old days, the resulting paste was passed through an olive press but nowadays it's more common to add water and centrifuge the mixture to separate the water and oil from the solid matter. The oil and water are then allowed to settle so that the olive oil layer can be decanted oft and bottled. "Difficult" olives are those that are more reluctant than the norm to yield up their full oil content. This may be attributable to the particular species of olive, or to its water content and the time of year the olives are collected—at the beginning and the end of the season their water content is often either too high or too low. These olives are easy to recognize because they produce a lot of extra foam during the stirring process, a consequence of an excess of a fine solid that acts as anatural emulsifier. The oil in this emulsion is lost when the water is disposed of. Not only that, if the waste water is disposed of directly into local fields—often the case in many smaller processing operations—the emulsified oil may take some time to biodegrade and so be harmful to the environment. "If you add between a it absorbs the half and two percent of talc by weightduring the stirring process, it absorbs the natural emulsifier in the olives and so boosts the amount of oil you can extract,"says Delord. "In addition, talc's flat, platey' structure helps increase the size of the oil droplets liberated during stirring, which again improves the yield. However, because talc is chemically inert, it doesn't affect the colour, taste, appearance or composition of the resulting olive oil."

If the use of talc in olive oil processing and in chewing gum is long established, new applications in the food and agriculture industries are also constantly being sought by Luzenac. One such promising new market is fruit crop protection, being pioneered in the US. Just like people, fruit can get sunburned. In fact, in very sunny regions up to 45 percent of atypical crop can be affected by heat stress and sunburn. However, in the case of fruit, it's not so much the ultra violet rays which harm the crop as the high surface temperature that the sun's rays create.

To combat this, farmers normally use either chemicals or spray a continuous fine canopy of mist above the fruit trees or bushes. The trouble is, this uses a lot of water—normally a precious commodity in hot, sunny areas—and it is therefore expensive. What's more, the ground can quickly become waterlogged." So our idea was to coat the fruit with talc to protect it from the sun,"says Greg Hunter, a marketing specialist who has been with Luzenac for ten years. "But to do this, several technical challenges had first to be overcome. Talc is very hydrophobic: it doesn't like water. So in order to have a viable product we needed a wettable powder—something that would go readily into suspension so that it could be sprayed onto the fruit. It also had to break the surface tension of the cutin (the natural waxy, waterproof layer on the fruit) and of course it had to wash off easily when the fruit was harvested. No-one's going to want an apple that's covered in talc." Initial trials in the state of Washington in 2003 showed that when the product was sprayed onto Granny Smith apples, it reduced their surface temperature and lowered the incidence of sunburn by up to 60 per cent. Today the new product, known as Invelop Maximum SPF, is in its second commercial year on the US market. Apple growers are the primary target although Hunter believes grape growers represent another sector with long term potential. He isalso hopeful of extending sales to overseas markets such as Australia, South America and southern Europe.

Complete the following summary below using NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the Reading Passage for each answer.

The use of talc powder in the olive oil industry in Spain has been around for **30** _____ years. It is extremely useful in dealing with "difficult" olives which often produce a lot of **31** _____ due to the high content of solid matter.

The traditional method of oil extraction used in some smaller plants often produces **32** _____ which contains emulsified oil, and if it is directly disposed of, it may be **33** _____ to the environment.

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

34 What is one key reason why chewing gum manufacturers prefer talc as a filler in gum base?

A) Talc enhances the flavor of the chewing gum.
B) Talc is chemically non-reactive, making it ideal for use in acidic gums.
C) Talc makes the gum base more elastic and chewy.
D) Talc is a more cost-effective option compared to other fillers.

35 How does talc help in the olive oil extraction process, especially with "difficult" olives?

A) It adds flavor to the olive oil and improves its aroma.
B) It absorbs the natural emulsifiers in the olives, boosting the oil yield.
C) It helps separate the oil from the water without the need for centrifugation.
D) It increases the water content in olives, making the extraction process easier.

MOCK TEST 66

35 answers

1 claims
2 medical
3 evidence
4 cancer
5 misunderstanding
6 cells
7 E
8 G
9 A
10 B
11 C
12 I
13 D
14 J
15 F
16 D
17 G
18 H
19 C
20 B
21 A / injecting goldfish at different stages of the experiments.
22 C / short and long-term memories are formed by separate processes.
23 A / Prompt memory formation underlies the performance of everyday tasks.
24 D / confirmed other experimental findings.
25 B / Activity in the brain gradually moved from one area to other areas.
26 Not Given
27 True
28 True
29 False
30 20 / twenty
31 foam
32 waste water / wastewater
33 harmful
34 B / Talc is chemically non-reactive, making it ideal for use in acidic gums.
35 B / It absorbs the natural emulsifiers in the olives, boosting the oil yield.